

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced
雅思口语高级
——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 11 Education

Topic 4—Lesson 1(上篇)

An exam you have taken



I. Pronunciation Practice (2 minutes)

Silent 'e' with Letter 'u'

Generally, letter 'u' makes the sound / ʌ / in words like cub;
however, when we add 'e' at the end of the word 'cube', 'u'
makes the sound / ju: /, and 'e' doesn't make a sound.

Read the following words and pay attention to the sound of 'u'.



cut / ʌ /

dup

hug

cute / ju: /

dupe

huge

II. IELTS Speaking Part 1 (8 minutes)



Extend your answer to 3-4 sentences. It's easier to get 7.5.

1. Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (4 minutes)

What is your lucky number, and **why**?

What is the most popular number in your country?

Do numbers have special meanings in your culture?



The examiner will score your answer from the following aspects:

1. How good you are at **keeping talking** at the right speed and **connecting your ideas together**;
2. **How much vocabulary** you have and **how well** you use it;
3. **How many structures** you have and **how well** you use them;
4. How well you **pronounce** the language.

2. Read and learn the following key words and models for the IELTS Part 1. You are suggested to apply these words in the following steps. (4 minutes)

Key Words and Models



occurrence

Example: I consider myself an intellectually inclined person, so I do not believe in luck or lucky numbers. I think luck is only a simplified human construct used to explain events or **occurrences** that could not be understood in the past. In the modern era I do not think luck has a place in explaining anything and science should be the only method used to explain events or occurrences.



at all costs

Example: The most popular number in China is the number four. It is actually more infamous than famous, because this number sounds similar to the Chinese word meaning death. Like the number thirteen in Western countries the number four is avoided **at all costs** in China. In China practically all buildings are missing the fourth floor and many people are reluctant to have the number in their telephone numbers as well.



auspicious

Example: Numbers in China do have special meanings, which is mainly because the sounds they make are similar to words in Chinese. For example, the numbers zero, six, eight, and nine are thought to have **auspicious** meanings because their pronunciations are similar to positive words in Chinese. Thus, these numbers are very popular in my country and many people regard them as lucky.

III. IELTS Speaking Part 2 (12 minutes)

1. *Brainstorm. Plan your answers based on the given questions. (1 minute)*

Describe an impressive exam you have taken.

- What exam did you take?
- When and where did the exam take place?
- How did you do on the exam?
- What were your feelings towards the exam?



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.1 Here is a model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (8 minutes)

Model 1

What exam you took: An exam that I took in the past and made a lasting impression on my psyche was an **anatomy** test in high school.

When and where the exam took place: I took the exam during the early morning hours on a very cold December day. I remember it well because it was the first exam of many that day. Since it was the last week of that school term, there were numerous obligations I had to complete.

How you did on the exam: That test set the mood for the rest of the day. Thankfully I did very well on the exam, which **boosted my confidence** so much that I was able to continue the streak on the rest of my tests.

How you felt about the exam: I think exams are an essential part of the education system, so I prepared all week for that exam. Undoubtedly, it is also important to get high marks in exams because it proves that you understand the material that you have spent months learning. What made the exam stand out among the rest was the unapologetic detail put into each diagram of the human body. The images were so vivid that it was **on par with** what I imagine an exam at the college level would look like. Overall, that exam changed my entire prospective of the human body and made me appreciate our frailty.



You are required to talk for the full 2 minutes.

2.2 Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (3 minutes)

Describe an impressive exam you have taken.

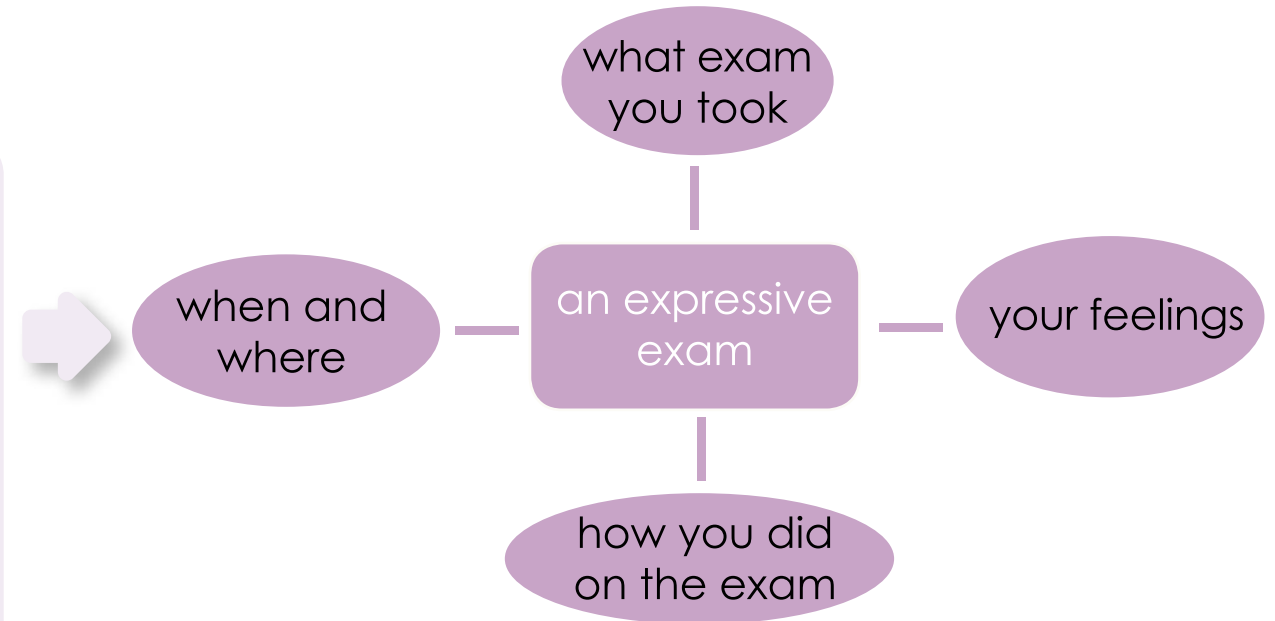
You should say:

what exam you took

when and where the exam took place

how you did on the exam

and **explain your feelings** towards the exam.



Homework: Please use the model for these two topics for further practice.

Describe an unforgettable experience.

Describe something you did well.

Review (2 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

occurrence

at all costs

auspicious

anatomy

boost one's confidence

on par with



Key Sentences

I think luck is only a simplified human construct used to explain events or **occurrences** that could not be understood in the past.

Like the number thirteen in Western countries the number four is avoided **at all costs** in China.

For example, the numbers zero, six, eight, and nine are thought to have **auspicious** meanings because their pronunciations are similar to positive words in Chinese.

An exam that I took in the past and made a lasting impression on my psyche was an **anatomy** test in high school.

Thankfully I did very well on the exam, which **boosted my confidence** so much that I was able to continue the streak on the rest of my tests.

The images were so vivid that it was **on par with** what I imagine an exam at the college level would look like.

You will learn more about this topic in Lesson 2.